Third, he is physically blessed with both an incredible sense of rhythm, which makes his bowling action appear so smooth and natural, and an incredibly powerful right wrist snap.

In so many ways, he's a classic predator with an instinctive ability to sense a weakness in the opposition and, in an instant, to find something deep within, to strike and to make the kill. He certainly proves too much for Bangladesh as we follow the 2–0 victory in the Test series with a 3–0 win in the ODIs that follow. Encouraged, we move on to play three Test matches against India in India.

Friday, 28 March 2008

It's the third day of the first Test against India at the MA Chidambaram Stadium in Chennai, and people are saying the temperature has reached 46 degrees Celsius, but that simple statement does not begin to describe the amazing experience of fielding in these conditions. This is cricket in a sauna. We are covered in sunscreen and, as I look around, we're all consistently drenched in sweat.

Adding to our general discomfort, Virender Sehwag is playing perhaps the best Test innings I have ever seen. We had thought we were in decent shape when Hashim's outstanding 159 helped us reach 520 in our first innings, but the outrageously gifted Indian opener is essentially playing T20 cricket in a Test, striking the ball so cleanly and batting on, and on and on … and, in the searing heat, we chase, and chase and chase.

'Veeru' eventually finishes with 319 runs from 304 balls. It is batting from another planet, but we stick to our task and Neil McKenzie's second-innings century ensures we salvage the draw.

Friday, 4 April 2008

I think it is happening. It is finally happening at the Sardar Patel Stadium